Track 3: Autonomous AI Teammates

Settled

Haan ya na?
Paytm asks before it charges.

For Paytm’s Soundbox, the payment speaker shops rent for about ₹125 a month. A yes is saved. A no stops the charge.

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Problem statement

Paytm shopkeepers get charged rent they never agreed to.

The salesman says

“Sirf ₹1 mahina.”

Next month

₹125 is cut from his payout.

Then

He complains and waits weeks.

Real complaints, 2023 to 2026

“...charged me Rs 125 monthly for 5-6 months automatically from my payments.”

App Store · Oct 2024

Box returned, but Soundbox rent still deducted.

Complaint site · Mar 2026

“My Rs 950 payment was adjusted against a Soundbox Monthly Rental... I have never ordered...”

LinkedIn · May 2026

Real complaints from Paytm merchants, 2023 to 2026. 1.64 crore merchants pay Paytm a subscription (Q2 FY27).

Proposed solution

Ask first, then charge

Before the first rent, Settled calls the shopkeeper, checks it’s really him, and asks in his language: did you agree to this plan?

“Haan”

A yes to the plan, then a yes to the price read back. Only then does rent run, and the yes is saved.

“Na” or unsure

Nothing is taken. Settled says sorry, a person calls back, and his choices go to WhatsApp. Only his own tap changes the plan.

No answer

Rent is held. It tries again, then a person calls.

Demo

Ramesh says na. Nothing is charged.

"Anil ne 24 October ko aapko ₹125 mahine wala plan diya tha, 1 November se. Kya aapne yahi plan liya tha?"

Anil gave you the ₹125 a month plan on 24 Oct, starting 1 Nov. Is this the plan you took?

"Na bhaiya, usne ₹1 bola tha."

No, he said ₹1.

"Maaf kijiye, aapko pareshani hui. Abhi kuch nahi katega. Hamari team sahi offer ke saath call karegi."

Sorry for the trouble. Nothing will be taken now. Our team will call you with the right offer.

Rent due 1 Nov — demo data

Gupta Kirana	"Haan", twice	**Charged, yes saved**
Ramesh, Sharma Store	"Na, he said ₹1"	**Held, WhatsApp sent**
Verma Dairy	Box never delivered, no call	**Not charged**

Then: Ramesh taps keep, switch or cancel on WhatsApp. Only his tap changes the plan.

Technology and tech stack

Sarvam for the voice, plain code for the money

Voice

Hears and speaks Hindi and other Indian languages, by phone or Soundbox (Sarvam Saaras v4, Bulbul v3).

Understanding

Understands mixed answers like “haan, par ₹1 bola tha” and hears when someone else answers. Questions go to a person (Sarvam-105B).

Rules

Code, not the AI, decides each charge. Every decision is logged.

Paytm systems

Built like Paytm’s own tools. Rent, app code, WhatsApp and pickup steps are mock-ups for the hackathon.

Records

Reads delivery, plan and sign-up records. If one can’t be reached, it asks a person.

Testing

New call: 13 of 14 simulated shopkeepers right, and nothing charged after a “na” or without the verified owner. First version: 62 of 62.

USP: what's different

A chatbot can ask. Settled can stop the money.

01 **Holds the money**

The charge waits in Paytm's payout system until there's a yes.

02 **Checks the records**

Delivery, return and plan records, before anyone is asked.

03 **Knows who said yes**

Before any question, it checks his name and a 4-digit code from his Paytm app, in plain code.

04 **Saves the sale honestly**

After a "na", it says sorry and takes nothing. A person calls back, and only his own tap changes the plan.

Impact and benefits

Who gains, and how we'll measure it

0

charges after a shopkeeper says "na"

1 day

target to settle a dispute, vs Paytm's 2-day promise

62

simulated shopkeepers in our test, scored by code

For shopkeepers

No surprise charges
Asked in their own language
A quick answer if they dispute

For Paytm

Fewer disputes and tickets
Proof behind every charge
Mis-selling found early
Merchants who stay

If 1 in 100 of 1.64 crore subscribers disputes a charge, that's about 1.6 lakh tickets.

Business model

Fewer disputes now, more merchants who stay

Now

New Soundbox sign-ups

Ask before the first rent. Fewer disputes, fewer tickets.

Next

Every recurring charge

Plan upgrades, loan deductions, insurance: same ask, same proof.

Later

Honest sales pay

Every “na” is tied to a salesman and area, so sales pay can reward honest sign-ups.

Why it pays: fewer refunds and support tickets now, and merchants who stay keep borrowing.
Over half of Paytm’s merchant loans go to repeat borrowers (Q1 FY27).

Our ask: a pilot on new Soundbox sign-ups.